

Tunnels

In busy cities, tunnels beneath the crowded streets are often the quickest way to get around. Other tunnels allow vehicles and trains to go right through mountains and under rivers and seas.

Digging a tunnel

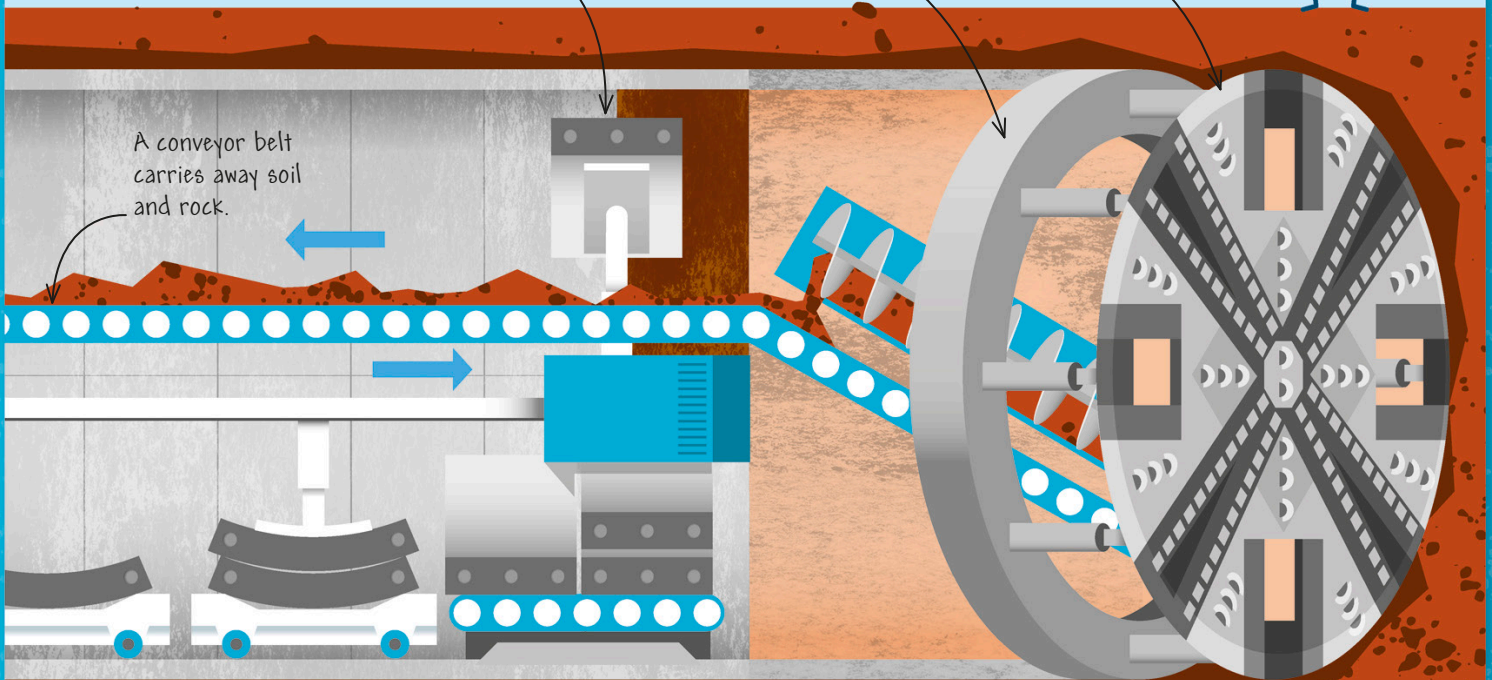
In the past, tunnels had to be dug by hand. Now we have machines to help!

The tunnel is lined with concrete.

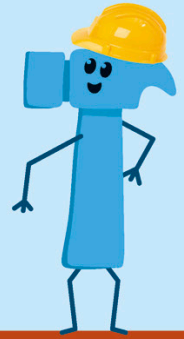
The machine pushes the cutting wheel forward.

The wheel spins and has sharp cutting teeth.

A conveyor belt carries away soil and rock.



There are tunnels for walkers, cyclists, cars, trains, water, electricity cables, phone lines, and even sewage!



Tunnel-boring machine

This machine is like a mechanical mole—it **bore**s, or digs, tunnels underground. It creeps forward slowly as the wheel at the front cuts away the soil and rock. As it moves, it lines the tunnel with concrete.

